

Dan Brandt

UX Designer

dbdoo.dev · portfolio and case studies
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UX designer trained in graphic and web design who designs mobile and web products and builds them too. I shipped an Android home screen app to Google Play as its sole designer, shaped by beta tester feedback. Years in support and customer-facing roles taught me where people get stuck, and why.

SELECTED WORK

dot.o Launcher · Android home screen, Google Play

2026 – present

Sole designer and developer · case study at dbdoo.dev/work/doto-launcher

- Designed a home screen with no grid, where apps and widgets sit anywhere on one canvas, and took it from concept to public release on Google Play.
- Ran a beta and turned tester feedback into shipped design changes: light themes for daylight use, controls moved within thumb reach, and a way to hold the screen still that one tester asked for three times.
- Replaced a seven-step onboarding tutorial with one-time hints that appear only when a gesture would help and disappear once used.
- Audited the appearance settings (15 overlapping controls, 6 names for one concept) and restructured them into complete looks plus six clearly named parts.
- Designed for accessibility: menus follow the phone's text size, touch targets are generous, and theme changes never override a user's motion settings.

Wide · Instagram carousel editor, Android beta

2026

Sole designer and developer · case study at dbdoo.dev/work/wide

- Designed an editor where a whole carousel is one continuous canvas, so photos and text can cross from one slide to the next.
- Borrowed print-style trim marks to keep slide edges readable on any photo, and merged layout editing with the export preview.
- Ran a UX consistency audit that unified animation timing across screens, and wrote a shared vocabulary naming every part of the interface.

Bid Tracker · client project, web

2026

Design and development, working directly with the business owner

- Ran discovery with a contractor whose bids, costs and receipts were spread across spreadsheets and text messages.
- Designed a phone-first app on top of the Google Sheet the business already used, with budget bars, receipts attached to their costs, and separate views for the team and the owner. In daily use.

EXPERIENCE

Independent UX Designer and Developer · self-employed

2026 – present

- Design and build apps, tools and websites for small businesses and my own products, from discovery through prototypes, testing and release. Clients include an artisan metalworker, a children's book series and a speech-language practice.

Technical Support Specialist · Sunlighten

2025 – 2026

- Guided owners through technical problems by phone, email and video, documenting each case and routing complex issues to the right team.

Sales and Technical Consultant · Google Fiber

2022 – 2023

- Explained networking to home and business customers and helped with setup; consistently exceeded targets.

Media Specialist · Life Time

2018 – 2019

- Produced training webinars and documentation for a multi-site company; shot and edited headshots.

DESIGN

Interaction design

User flows

Prototyping

Usability and beta testing

Design audits

Design systems

Accessibility

UX writing

Visual and UI design

Typography

Motion design

TOOLS

Figma

Photo editing

AI-assisted prototyping

BUILD

I prototype and ship in code, so designs survive to release.

Kotlin and Android

Flutter and Dart

React and Next.js

HTML, CSS, JavaScript

Git and GitHub

EDUCATION

Graphic Design and Web Design, A.A.S.

Hennepin Technical College,
2014 – 2018

Full Stack Development Bootcamp

University of Minnesota, 2024